

Launch of CETLS

A research centre for learning sciences and technology across the lifespan

THE OCCASION

You are invited to inaugurate the Centre for Education Technology and Learning Sciences (CETLS) at IIIT Hyderabad. CETLS is a new research centre devoted to the science and design of learning from childhood through later life. Its purpose is to place India on the international stage of the learning sciences — not only as a site of implementation, but as a source of original research, open infrastructure, and practice that others can learn from.

WHAT THE CENTRE STANDS FOR

Vision

A future in which every learner — from school through higher education, professional life, and the third age — has access to adaptive, engaging, and equitable learning grounded in the science of how people learn.

Mission

To advance rigorous research and design at the intersection of learning sciences, artificial intelligence, and educational technology — producing knowledge and tools that are effective, inclusive, and scalable for India and the Global South, and that contribute to the global research community.

THE INTELLECTUAL SPINE

In the age of AI, every education system must answer four questions. CETLS organises all of its research around them, adapted to each stage of life:

01

What should be learned

02

How teaching should be designed

03

How people learn with technology

04

How progress should be evaluated

FOUR DOMAINS ACROSS THE LIFESPAN

01 K–12 Education

School learning in the age of AI, grounded in Indian classrooms, multilingual systems, teacher capacity, and NEP 2020.

02 Higher Education

Teaching, learning, and assessment in universities and colleges for an AI-transformed world and a more flexible academy.

03 Professionals & Executives

Adaptive, high-impact continuous learning that fits the realities of work, leadership, and large, diverse workforces.

04 Third-Age Learning

Technology-supported learning that enables older adults to continue learning, connecting, and participating with dignity.

FLAGSHIP PLATFORM — LEARNING MIDDLEWARE

CETLS is building an open technology layer so that the methods of the learning sciences are available to teachers, faculty, institutions, and researchers — rather than remaining locked inside individual projects. Released as open source, the Learning Middleware is intended to lower barriers and accelerate evidence-based innovation across all four domains. This is the Centre's distinctive contribution: research plus shared infrastructure.

SUGGESTED POINTS FOR REMARKS

1. Learning is a lifespan endeavour. National capability depends on it from the first classroom to later life — not only on degrees.
2. AI does not merely add tools; it changes what is worth learning, how we teach, how people learn, and how we can honestly assess. Those are research questions, not slogans.
3. India can lead if we combine the learning sciences with open infrastructure and the real conditions of our schools, campuses, workplaces, and ageing communities.
4. CETLS is IIIT Hyderabad's commitment to that agenda: a centre that will produce knowledge the world can use, and tools the field can share.

THE CHIEF GUEST'S ROLE

To inaugurate the Centre; to lend public weight to a lifespan, evidence-based agenda for learning in the age of AI; and to signal that India intends to contribute original research and open infrastructure to the world, not only to adopt tools designed elsewhere.